ZIL MONEY / KNOWLEDGE BASE

The Zil Money v4 UI Rebrand and Consistency Pass

A plain-language, phase-by-phase guide to the colour theme, the shared components, and how every screen stays consistent

PRODUCT	WORKSTREAM	AUDIENCE	STATUS
Zil Money web app (v4)	design/zilmoney-rebrand	Design, Dev, QA, PM	In design review

Overview

The v4 UI rebrand and consistency pass gives the Zil Money web app **one colour system, one button system and one set of component states**, applied the same way on every screen. The work started as a palette change (a slate primary became the navy `#004a7c` with a teal `#00a5b2` accent) and grew into a consistency programme: wherever two screens solved the same problem in two ways, one way now wins, and that way is written down.

Before this pass, colours lived in three places at once: theme tokens, hand-typed hex values inside components, and leftovers from the previous indigo palette. Dropdowns came in several heights and radii, buttons were sometimes real components and sometimes hand-rolled, and dark mode turned every brand card into a glowing block. Each screen looked fine on its own. Side by side, the seams showed.

The journey, in plain terms:

- Every colour becomes a theme token with a light and a dark value, and components stop carrying their own hex codes.
- Shared components (button, input, dropdown, modal shell, empty and loading states) become the only way to build those things.
- Screens are reviewed one by one against the tokens and the shared recipes, and the stragglers are brought in line.
- The result is documented as a reference and a change log, so the next person builds the same way without asking.

FACT	DETAIL
Scope	All v4 screens of the Zil Money web app: dashboard, main pages, Send Payment, payee and category modals, wallet and bank lists, demo and support modals.
Primary palette	Navy primary `#004a7c`, teal accent `#00a5b2`, light-blue page `#f2f7fb`. Dark mode swaps every token on the same markup.
Accessibility bar	WCAG 2.2 AA app-wide: text 4.5:1, control boundaries 3:1, no status by colour alone. A script in the repo checks the token pairs.
Comparison builds	Three local builds that differ only in colour (navy, the earlier indigo, a calm teal) so stakeholders can compare palettes on identical screens.
Status	Design pass complete on the design branch. Not yet merged. Review pack delivered to the dev and QA teams.

How we talk about it (guardrails)

- This is a design-branch pass. Nothing here is live until the dev team merges it through the normal pipeline.
- "Consistent" means the same token and the same recipe, not merely "looks similar".
- The accessibility bar is a hard rule. A softer look never buys its way past a contrast failure.
- Open items are listed honestly. Anything not fixed is named, with the reason.

Knowledge

The master brief. Read this once and you understand what changed and why.

The work in full

The pass has four strands that ran together:

Colour. The app's palette is expressed as roughly 120 theme tokens in two files (light and dark). This pass retired the last hand-typed colours in v4 screens, moved brand surfaces onto a banner token that becomes a deep navy in dark mode, promoted the teal accent to the call-to-action colour on brand surfaces, and replaced the slate accent on feature icon tiles with the primary.

Consistency. Same problem, same solution. Dropdown rows, "Add new" tiles, list dividers, modal surfaces, container borders and masked account numbers were each unified to one recipe. A read-only audit of buttons, dropdowns, modals, tables and state components produced the list of outliers; the safe ones were fixed and the rest were recorded.

Simplicity. Two long modals were restructured so they read as one short form: a visible entity choice, optional sections behind quiet chips that open one at a time, and dead controls removed.

Documentation. A UI reference (tokens, button variants and states, component states) and a dated change log now live in the repo, with shareable Word, HTML and Markdown copies.

What changed, screen by screen

SCREEN	CHANGE
Dashboard, Bulk Payment Center	Hard-coded indigo tiles and buttons replaced with white tints; "Coming Soon" on warning tokens; teal main action; dark-mode-safe card surface.
Main pages (Payables, Receivables, Business Tools, Accounts, Services, Settings)	All slate feature tiles moved to the primary; CTA banner button became the teal fill; banner background on the dark-aware token.
Accounts page	"Introducing Zil Money Wallet" extracted into a shared component and compacted.
Instant Demo modal	Highlight text and ticks made visible on the blue panel; "Talk to an expert now" is the primary action while someone is online.
Add Category modal	One surface for header, body and footer.
Add payee / customer / vendor / employee modal	Lighter container borders; separate entity chooser; optional-details chip row with single-open panels; send-link checkboxes removed in favour of live status lines.
Wallet list	Dividers match bank and card lists; selection rail no longer shifts rows.
Send Payment dropdowns	One row recipe across all nine dropdowns; number beside the name; four-dot mask; identical "Add new" tile.

SCREEN	CHANGE
Global	Dropdown radius unified; hover token defined; hard-coded greys tokenised; checkbox and radio focus and disabled states fixed; typos and stray hex values removed.

Who benefits

For users: screens read as one product. Dark mode is calm. Forms feel short because the optional parts stay out of the way until asked for. Keyboard users get a visible focus ring everywhere.

For the team: a new screen can be built from the reference without a design review for the basics. A colour change is a token edit, not a hunt through components. The audit's open items are a ready-made backlog.

Internal FAQ

- *Why teal on the banner buttons when white text on teal is only about 3:1?* It was chosen on review for brand reasons. It is noted as below the 4.5:1 text target and is the one deliberate exception.
- *Why were field borders not lightened app-wide?* The field border sits at the 3:1 boundary floor on the page background. Anything lighter fails the contrast script.
- *Why does the Add payee modal still have three optional sections?* Address, bank account and more-info are needed for some payees. They are now chips that open one at a time rather than four identical accordions.
- *Is any of this in production?* No. It is on the design branch and in the three comparison builds.

Definition of success

The Knowledge phase is done when any designer or developer can read this pack and the UI reference, name the token or recipe for a given element without asking, and explain which exceptions exist and why.

02 | BA

BA

Objective

Agree how we will know the rebrand and consistency pass worked, in measurable terms, before it ships.

Investigation and analysis

Most of the value here is qualitative, so the measures lean on things that can be counted in the codebase and in review, with a small set of user-facing checks after release.

Thinking seed

- Count of hand-typed hex colours in v4 templates and styles. The baseline before this pass was in the dozens; the target is zero outside documented exceptions.
- Count of distinct dropdown and button recipes in the v4 app. The audit found several of each; the target is one per component.
- Contrast script result: every token pair passes, every build, as a gate.
- Guardrail: no regression in form completion on Send Payment and Add payee after the modal restructure.
- Guardrail: zero accessibility defects raised against focus visibility or colour-only status.

Working strategy

Record the baseline counts from the audit, keep the contrast script in the pipeline, and schedule one post-release review of the two restructured modals with support tickets as the signal.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the counts above have a baseline, a target and an owner, the contrast gate is agreed, and the post-release review is on the calendar.

03 | To Do

To Do

Objective

Turn the design-branch work into merge-ready, reviewable pieces.

Investigation and analysis

The branch holds roughly 620 changed files, most of them from the earlier accessibility pass. They split naturally into: tokens and global styles, shared components, page-level changes, modal restructures, and documentation.

Thinking seed

- Which slice can merge first with the lowest risk? Tokens and global style fixes change the look everywhere but touch few files.
- Which changes alter behaviour rather than style? The Add payee restructure and the send-link form are the two to review as features, with tests.
- What is the Definition of Done for a style change: contrast script green, lint clean, screens clicked through in light and dark.

Working strategy

Open one pull request per slice, in the order tokens, global styles, shared components, pages, modals, docs. Link the change log section for each. Flag the two behavioural changes for QA.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the branch is split into reviewable pull requests with acceptance criteria, the behavioural changes are flagged, and the Definition of Done is agreed.

UI/UX

This is the phase that carries the full design depth. The rules below are the ones every other phase relies on.

Colour theme

Brand

- Primary `#004a7c` (dark `#1d6aa5`)
- Brand text in dark mode `#8ec5ec`
- Teal accent `#00a5b2` (both modes)
- Brand banner, dark mode `#0c3d63`

Surfaces

- Page `#f2f7fb` (dark `#162034`)
- Card and input `#ffffff` (dark `#1c293c`)
- Container border `#e5e7eb` (dark `#3a3e47`)
- Field border `#7c8fa3` (dark `#6b7a90`)

Text

- Main `#111827`
- Secondary `#374151`
- Tertiary `#4b5563`
- Subtle and placeholder `#6b7280`

Status

- Success `#047857` on `#d1fae5`
- Warning `#a16207` on `#fef9c2`
- Error `#b91c1c` on `#ffe2e2`
- Info `#004a7c` on `#e6eff6`

> **Rules.** Containers use the container border; only form fields use the field border. Status chips stay light in dark mode. Compliance notices are neutral, never red; only enhanced due diligence is amber. Verified bank accounts show a tick and a short "ACH" chip, never the word "Verified".

Buttons

VARIANT	RECIPE
Primary	Navy fill, white text, 44px, 14px semibold, 8px radius. One per view or modal.
Outline	White fill, 2px navy border, brand text. The Cancel and secondary action.
Destructive	Red fill, white text. Confirm dialogs only.
Compact	32px, 13px, 4px radius. Toolbars, cards, table actions.
On brand surfaces	Main action is the teal fill with white text; supporting actions are a 15% white tint with a 30% white border.
States	Hover darkens 8% and lifts; focus shows a 2px brand ring; active presses to 98%; disabled is 45% opacity and desaturated; loading disables the button and spins a 16px icon after the label.

Component states

- **Fields:** 44px, field border, brand border plus ring on focus, red border and a shaking message on error after the field is touched, 50% opacity when disabled, red asterisk for required, "(optional)" in the label

otherwise.

- **Dropdowns:** 44px control, 12px radius, brand border on hover and when open, 2px brand border once a value is chosen, 12px panel with 44px rows and a 240px scroll height. In modals the panel attaches to the body so it never clips.
- **Choice rows:** 28px icon tile that fills navy when selected, 13px bold name with the masked number beside it, page-tint hover, brand-tint selection, 3px gap between rows, dashed green "Add new" tile at the top.
- **Modals:** 20px shell, one surface for header, body and footer, title 20px semibold with a 12px subtitle, close icon top right, Cancel outline then primary at 120px each.
- **Empty:** one white card with a 60px icon circle, 18px title, one helper line and one compact primary action. Never a fake list skeleton.
- **Loading:** shimmer skeletons for tables and panels, a spinning icon inline, a full-screen blurred overlay only for whole-page waits.
- **Feedback:** centred alert dialogs for success, failure, info and warning; inline banners on the success, warning and error surfaces; no toasts.

Simplicity patterns from this pass

- Required fields in one card. A clear, separate choice (Individual or Business) with pill buttons that say what the choice changes.
- Optional sections as a single row of dashed chips, opened one at a time, with a tick once completed and a red "Required" tag when a choice makes them mandatory.
- Controls that only mirror derived state are removed and replaced with a status line, as with the send-link checkboxes.

Definition of success

The phase is done when every v4 element can be traced to a token and a recipe in the UI reference, dark mode is reviewed on every changed screen, and the deliberate exceptions are listed with their contrast figures.

Compliance Sign-off

Objective

Confirm the pass changes nothing about what data is collected or shown, and that accessibility obligations are met.

Investigation and analysis

The restructured Add payee modal moves fields around but collects the same data. The send-link form still sends the same email and SMS flags; it only removed controls that could not be operated. No new personal data is captured and no masking was weakened: account numbers are still shown as the last four digits only.

Thinking seed

- Does the four-dot mask beside the name reveal anything the previous format did not? It shows the same last four digits.
- Does the Individual or Business choice change which fields are required in a way Legal needs to know? It makes company name and address required for a business, as before.
- Is the accessibility bar documented well enough to cite in an audit?

Working strategy

Walk Compliance through the two restructured forms with before-and-after screenshots, confirm no change to data capture, consent or masking, and attach the contrast report.

Definition of success

The phase is done when Compliance confirms no change to data collection or exposure, and the accessibility evidence is accepted.

Development

Objective

Merge the design-branch work safely, keep the token system as the single source of colour, and leave the codebase easier to extend.

Investigation and analysis

The concrete surfaces engineering will touch: the light and dark theme files and the theme emitter that turns them into CSS variables; the Tailwind config that maps those variables to utility classes; the global overrides file for dropdowns, checkboxes and radios; the shared button, input, dropdown and main-page layout components; the page data file that assigns icon colours to feature tiles; and the Add payee, Add Category and Instant Demo modal components. The new shared wallet intro component and the two documents under the design-system docs folder are additions.

Thinking seed

- Keep the three colour builds in step. Every change goes to the main copy, then the sync script re-applies it to the other two with their colour swap.
- The dropdown height tiers exist twice. Decide which set survives and delete the other before more screens are added.
- Forty hand-rolled primary buttons remain in twenty-four files. Migrate them to the shared button in a dedicated pull request.
- Modal shells are repeated by hand in over a hundred templates. A shared shell component would retire most of the remaining inconsistency.
- The error message component still uses a FontAwesome icon; the repo standard is Lucide.

Working strategy

Merge in slices as planned in To Do, run the contrast script and lint on each, click through light and dark for every touched screen, and keep the UI reference and change log current as part of the pull request.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the slices are merged, no v4 screen carries a hard-coded colour outside documented exceptions, the contrast gate is green, and the docs match what shipped.

QA Scheduled

Objective

Plan a visual and functional test pass that covers every changed screen in both themes.

Investigation and analysis

The change log lists the screens. The behavioural changes are the Add payee modal (entity choice, optional chips, send link) and the Instant Demo modal (primary action depends on expert availability). Everything else is visual.

Thinking seed

- Edge cases: a business payee saved without an address; an individual payee with a company name; a send link with phone only; edit mode on an existing payee; no expert online in the demo modal.
- Theme cases: every changed screen in light and dark, including the brand banners and the demo modal's blue panel.
- Keyboard: tab through the entity pills, the optional chips and the dropdown rows; the focus ring must be visible at every stop.

Working strategy

Write the cases from the change log, pair each with a screenshot from the reference, and assign a tester and a date.

Definition of success

The phase is done when every changed screen has a light and a dark case, the behavioural edge cases are written, and the keyboard pass is scheduled.

In QA

Objective

Run the cases and prove the screens match the reference in both themes.

Investigation and analysis

Compare each screen with the screenshots captured during the design pass. Differences in spacing, radius, hover or selection are defects even when the colour is right.

Thinking seed

- Does a dropdown panel inside a modal ever clip at the modal edge?
- Does the Add payee modal still submit correctly for each payee type and entity choice?
- Do the three comparison builds show identical layouts, differing only in colour?

Working strategy

Execute the plan, log defects against the change log entry they relate to, and re-test fixes in both themes.

Definition of success

The phase is done when every case has passed in both themes and no open defect touches a changed screen.

09 | QA Passed

QA Passed

Objective

Record that the pass is verified and ready to release.

Investigation and analysis

Collect the evidence: the executed test plan, the contrast report, lint and unit test results, and the final screenshots per theme.

Thinking seed

- Is every defect closed or explicitly deferred with an owner?
- Does the UI reference still match the verified screens?

Working strategy

Attach the evidence to the epic and update the status in the reference document.

Definition of success

The phase is done when QA has signed off with the evidence attached and the reference reflects the verified state.

Deployment

Objective

Ship the merged slices through the normal pipeline with a clean way back.

Investigation and analysis

Style changes are low risk individually but highly visible together. Shipping tokens first changes the look everywhere at once; shipping pages first leaves a mixed state. Tokens and global styles should go together, then the rest.

Thinking seed

- Does the white-label build for every brand still look right? A shared token change reaches all of them.
- Is the rollback a plain revert of the merge, with no data or config to undo?
- Is dark mode checked on the deployed build, not only locally?

Working strategy

Deploy slice by slice through the pipeline, check a brand build and both themes after each, and keep the revert path ready.

Definition of success

The phase is done when all slices are deployed, every brand build is checked, and the rollback path is confirmed unused or exercised cleanly.

Sales and Support Training

Objective

Make sure support can answer "the screen looks different" questions calmly and accurately.

Investigation and analysis

The visible changes customers may ask about: the navy and teal look, a darker and calmer dark mode, the shorter Add payee form with the Individual or Business choice, and the send-link form without checkboxes.

Thinking seed

- What does a user do if they cannot find the address fields? They are behind the Address chip under "Add optional details".
- What changed in the send-link form? The link goes to every channel they fill in; the checkboxes were never real controls.
- Nothing about pricing, limits or data handling changed.

Working strategy

Give support a one-page before-and-after with the four visible changes and the answers above.

Definition of success

The phase is done when support has the one-pager and can walk a customer through the Add payee form without escalation.

Marketing Training

Objective

Align public screenshots and brand assets with the new palette.

Investigation and analysis

Marketing material that shows app screens will look dated once the navy and teal ship. The palette values and the dark-mode rules are in the reference.

Thinking seed

- Which public pages and help articles show the old indigo screens?
- Should dark-mode screenshots be used anywhere? The dark palette is now presentable.

Working strategy

Share the palette card from the reference and a set of refreshed screenshots after deployment.

Definition of success

The phase is done when marketing has the palette and refreshed screenshots, and no live asset shows the retired palette.

Live BA Dashboard Preview

Objective

Show the measures from the BA phase on real data before management sign-off.

Investigation and analysis

The codebase counts (hard-coded colours, distinct recipes) come from a repository scan; the contrast gate comes from the pipeline; the form-completion guardrail comes from product analytics.

Thinking seed

- Is the hard-coded colour count at zero outside the documented exceptions?
- Has Send Payment or Add payee completion moved since release?
- Is anything presented as live that is still a manual count?

Working strategy

Present the counts and the guardrail trend with their sources, and label anything manual as such.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the measures are shown from their real sources and any gap has a named owner.

Management Approval

Objective

Get an explicit decision that the new look and the consistency rules are the standard going forward.

Investigation and analysis

Management chooses between the three colour builds and confirms the teal accent and the dark-mode navy. The two deliberate contrast exceptions need an explicit yes.

Thinking seed

- Navy, indigo or teal primary? The comparison builds exist for this decision.
- Is white text on the teal accent accepted as an exception, or should the fill be darkened?
- Is the open-items list funded as follow-up work?

Working strategy

Present the three builds on identical screens, the exception list with contrast figures, and the open-items backlog. Record the decisions.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the palette, the exceptions and the follow-up backlog are each decided with a named approver.

Done

Objective

Close the pass with the reference as the living standard.

Investigation and analysis

Confirm the deployed app matches the reference, the change log is complete, and the comparison builds are archived or retired.

Thinking seed

- Is the reference linked from the repo's contributor guide so new screens follow it?
- Are the two worktrees for colour comparison still needed?

Working strategy

Link the docs, retire the comparison builds once the palette is decided, and write the closing summary.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the reference is the linked standard, the comparison builds are retired, and the epic has a written summary.

BA Review

Objective

Check whether the pass achieved its goals and decide what comes next.

Investigation and analysis

Compare the codebase counts and guardrails with the baseline, and review how many new screens since release followed the reference without correction.

Thinking seed

- Did the recipe count stay at one per component, or did new variants creep in?
- Which open items caused real friction and should move up the backlog?
- Does the reference need a section it is missing?

Working strategy

Run the scan again, read the recent screens against the reference, and update the open-items list and the document.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the results are compared with the baseline, the follow-up work is prioritised, and the reference is updated.

Open items carried forward BACKLOG

ITEM	WHY IT IS OPEN
Modal shells	Most modal headers still use a different surface token; no shared shell component exists yet.
Dropdown height tiers	Two systems coexist. One must be deleted.
Hand-rolled buttons	Forty remain across twenty-four files with mixed radius and hover.
Error message icon	Uses FontAwesome; the standard is Lucide.
Empty-field border class	A legacy red border class is applied to empty inputs and only hidden by cascade order.
Field border softness	Any lighter value fails the 3:1 boundary check; needs a decision, not a tweak.
Teal CTA text contrast	White on teal is about 3:1; accepted on review as an exception.